LESSON 00 · MISSION GUIDE

The Guild Hall Door

Set up your desk, meet the guild, and fix your first page of Dalvric's code.

From **Queen Aldara of Thornmere**
To **Jen, Keeper of the Guild Ledger**
By raven **A royal welcome (and a small favour)**

Jen, welcome to the Adventurers' Guild of Thornmere! Sending heroes after goblins, trolls and the occasional Wyrm for three hundred years, and writing it all down for exactly as long.

A small confession. Every quest the guild has ever posted is recorded by the **Grimoire of Dalvric**, about 4,000 lines of incantations left by a court wizard who sailed west in 1019 and never came back. It fails every full moon. Nobody dares touch it. The guild's **Royal Charter** is up for renewal at Midsummer, and I will only sign it if someone can show me, properly, which quests are worth the crowns. Everyone keeps telling me "Python" is the answer.

We do not know what a Python is, but we have approved the budget (it is free, which we like). Today: get your desk set up and say hello. Tea is in the kitchens. Do not let Biscuit near the abacus. — A.

Meet the guild

Queen Aldara. Sends decrees at dusk on the last day of the week. "No pressure. (Some pressure.)"

Orrin of the Clockworks. Keeps the guild's machines running. Has seen things.

Dalvric the Vanished, court wizard, sailed west in 1019. His torn pages turn up in every lesson, always broken.

Pell, the Quartermistress, keeper of the guild's stores and accounts. Sharp, busy, and the source of most of your ravens.

Captain Siv, quest master. Hands out the quests. Needs yes or no, never "mayhap".

Biscuit, a small kitchen dragon. Not allowed near the abacus. Often near the abacus.

What you'll be able to do after today

- [ ] Install Python, VS Code and Git on your own computer
- [ ] Run Python three ways: the interactive prompt, a script, and the ▶ button
- [ ] Explain **repository, commit, branch** and **pull request** in your own words
- [ ] Write a small script, run it, and check it against the expected output
- [ ] Read an error message and find **which line** is broken and **what kind** of problem it is

Why this matters at work

- **VBA lives inside a workbook. Python lives outside.** A Python script can read 300 quest scrolls overnight without anyone clicking "Enable macros".
- **Git is Track Changes for code**, with a full audit trail: who changed what, when, and why. The Royal Auditors like audit trails.
- **A script does the same thing every time**, unlike copy-paste at dusk on the last day of the week.

How today works

BEFORE	15 MIN	45 MIN	15 MIN
Setup	**Lecture**	**Exercise sheet**	**Grimoire, page 0**
Follow `SETUP.md`, 30–45 min	Lars shows how it all fits together	Write it all yourself, on your own	Fix Dalvric's welcome script

Your three documents

GUIDE.pdf	This one. What's going on and why.
EXERCISES.pdf	The exercise sheet. Five exercises; you write every file yourself in `my_work/`.
CHEATSHEET.pdf	One page of commands. Keep it open while you work.

How to check your work

There's no marking robot. Every exercise shows the **expected output**. Run your file and compare: same output means done. If you get an error instead, read it like this:

```
PS> python my_work/hello.py
  File "my_work/hello.py", line 2                    ← WHERE: file and line
    print("A reward of 1,000 crowns split 3 ways is", 1000 / 3
          ^
SyntaxError: '(' was never closed                    ← WHAT went wrong
```

Read the **last line** first (what went wrong), then go to the **line number** (where). An error message isn't a telling-off. It's Python pointing at the problem for you.

You're done when...

- [ ] `my_work/` contains `hello.py` and `about_me.py`, and both print the expected output
- [ ] Dalvric's page runs and prints the three expected lines
- [ ] Everything is pushed to `lesson-00` and you've opened a pull request



Next lesson: The Notice Board. Seven ravens, one failed Grimoire, and the Queen wants the guild's record "in one sentence". You'll learn how Python handles numbers, text and formatting: rewards, shares, and notices that don't look like 1019.